



Fred Slade

1893 - 1916

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	Fred Slade NB he was born and registered as Fred, never Frederick or Alfred	CWGC
Date of Birth	Jul-Sep 1893 Born Knutsford, Cheshire. Registered in Sep Qtr, 1893, Altrincham Reg District	1911 census, GRO index
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	9/09/1916	CWGC
Age at death (from Spreadsheet)	23	CWGC
Marital Status	Single – from obituary	
Children (if any)	None – from obituary	
Occupation prior to Call up	Clerk working for a Paper Making Merchant in	1911 census

	1911 which I'm assuming is the one mentioned in the obituary Obituary mentions him working in the export department of Messrs Edward Lloyd Ltd where he remained till outbreak of war	Obituary in the Harrow Observer
Parents	William and Emma Slade	CWGC, 1911 census
Listed Address(s)	Neotsford, 89 Longley Road, Harrow Family lived in Romiley, Cheshire in 1901	CWGC, 1911 census, Harrow Observer 1901 census
Parents /Fathers occupation	Accountant working for the Railway	1911 census
Brothers and Sisters	George W, Henry (both older) NB Henry was injured and George killed in the war and this is reported below in the Harrow Observer article. Ethel (older)	1901 & 1911 census, Harrow Observer 1901 census
Years at John Lyon School	Entered school in 1905	Harrow Observer obituary see below
University (if any)	Appears he went straight to work after school	Harrow Observer obituary see below
Obituary	Harrow Observer 6/10/1916	See below includes pics
Additional sources of data		
War Memorials:	Knutsford & District Memorial Hospital (George is also commemorated here) John Lyon School memorial Neither brother is on the Harrow on the Hill memorial, the St John the Baptist memorial or St Peter's Church memorial	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/358913

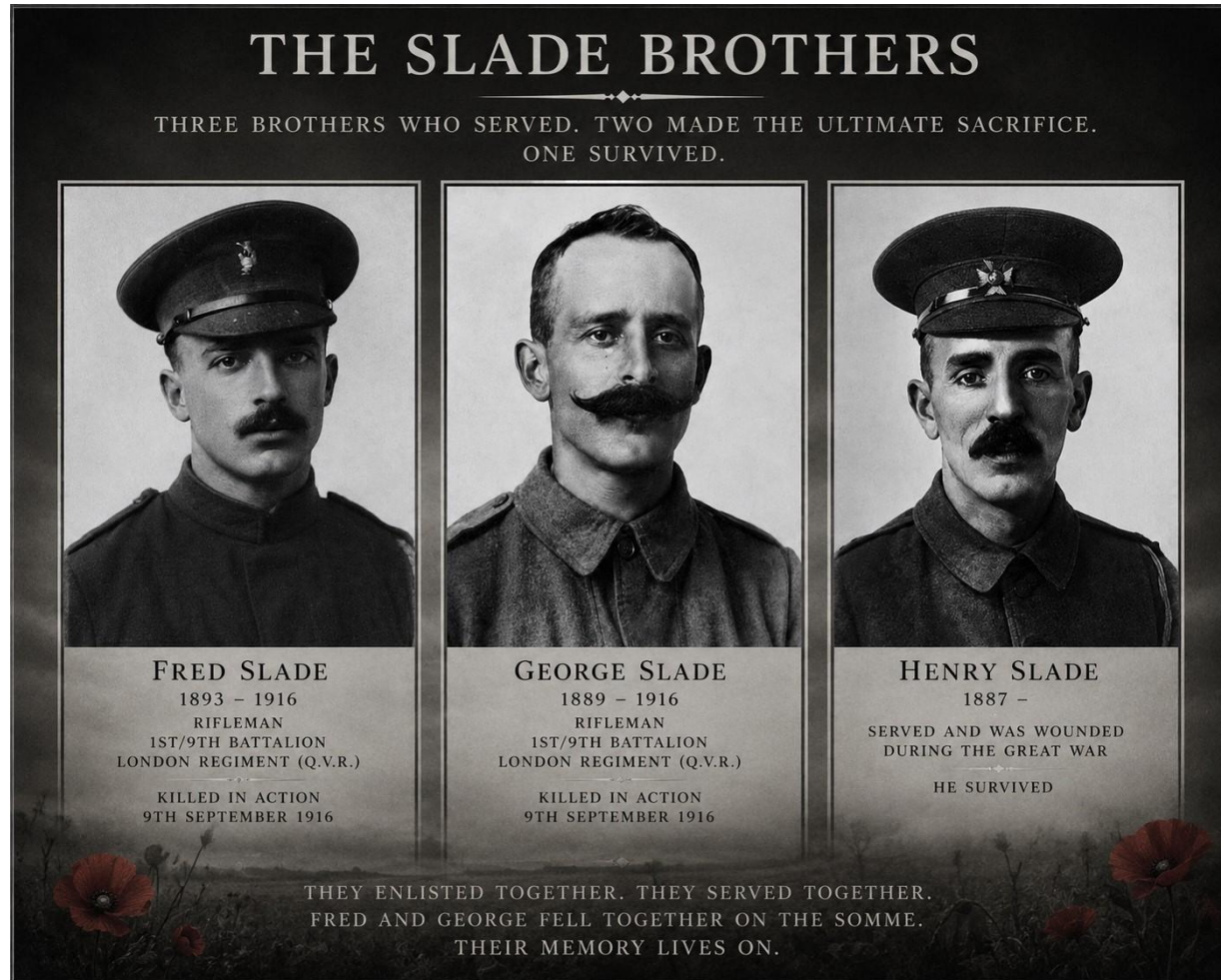
Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	SLADE F.
CWGC Reference	https://www.cwgc.org/find-war-dead/casualty/609882/slade,-fred/
Age	23
DoD	09-Sep-16
Rank	Rfn
Regiment	London Regiment (Queen Victoria's Rifles) "D" Coy. 1st/9th Bn
	<u>SERRE ROAD CEMETERY No.2</u>
Location	Somme, France
Military details	Son of William and E. Slade, of 89, Longley Rd., Harrow, Middx. London Regiment die in WW1 Rifleman Fred Slade (Service Number 5872) died on September 9, 1916, at the age of 23. He served with the 1st/9th Battalion of the London Regiment (Queen Victoria's Rifles), fighting as part of the 169th Brigade within the 56th (London) Division. (Note: Before joining the Queen Victoria's Rifles, he initially served as Private 2714 in the 9th Battalion of the Middlesex Regiment). Rifleman Slade is buried at the CWGC Serre Road Cemetery No. 2 in France (Plot XV, Row E, Grave 12). The actions that took his life occurred on the Somme battlefield, specifically during a fierce assault just southwest of Bouleaux Wood and Leuze Wood, near the villages of Ginchy and Combles in northern France. He was killed in action during the Battle of Ginchy, a major phase of the wider Battle of the Somme. On the afternoon of September 9, 1916, at 4:45 PM, a coordinated British attack was launched to clear the German strongpoints holding out between Ginchy and the heavily fortified Bouleaux Wood. The 1st/9th London (Queen Victoria's Rifles) advanced on the far right flank of the assault, tasked with charging across open, muddy ground to capture a series of German trenches southeast of Leuze Wood. As the battalion stepped off, they were immediately met with devastating, pre-ranged machine-gun crossfire firing directly from the dense undergrowth of Bouleaux Wood, alongside a heavy artillery barrage. The terrain was heavily cratered and slick with mud, slowing the advance and making the men highly visible targets. The battalion suffered immense casualties during the charge, and Rifleman Slade was among the heavy wave of soldiers killed out in No Man's Land during the frantic frontline fighting. Because Serre Road Cemetery No. 2 was used extensively after the armistice to rebury casualties gathered from the surrounding Somme battlefields, his body was later recovered and given a permanent, marked grave.

Story of Sacrifice

Fred Slade (1893 – 1916)

Fred Slade was born in Cheshire before moving to Harrow and attending John Lyon School. He was one of three brothers, only one of whom survived the First World War. Fred died on the same day, in the same battle as his brother George.



Civilian Life

Fred Slade was born in Knutsford, Cheshire, in 1893, the youngest son of William and Emma Slade. The family later moved to Harrow, where Fred attended the Lower School of John Lyon. After leaving school, he entered the Export Department of Messrs Edward Lloyd Ltd., where he remained until shortly after the outbreak of the First World War. The Harrow Observer remembered him as someone who, in his school, business, social and home life, was “cheerful and happy”, earning the respect and affection of those around him.

Fred came from a family whose three sons would all be affected by the war. His elder brother George had worked for the Great Central Railway and, after the family moved to Harrow, on the staff of the Chief Goods Manager at Marylebone. George was described as an all-round sportsman who had captained several local clubs and was held in high esteem by his friends. Their other brother, Henry, also served and was wounded, but survived.

Military Life

Fred initially joined the 5th Battalion, Middlesex Regiment, but subsequently transferred to the Queen Victoria’s Rifles because he wanted to serve alongside his brothers. In early 1916, he and George enlisted in the 1st/9th Battalion, London Regiment (Queen Victoria’s Rifles), with Fred receiving service number 5872 and George 5808. Together they went to France on 12 July 1916.

On 9 September 1916, Fred and George were both killed during the fighting on the Somme. Fred was 23. The battalion took part in the attack during the Battle of Ginchy, advancing across difficult ground towards German positions near Bouleaux and Leuze Woods. Fred was killed during the fighting and was later buried at Serre Road Cemetery No. 2 in France.

The circumstances of the brothers' deaths made the family's loss particularly severe: Fred and George had enlisted together, served in the same regiment and company, travelled to France together, and died on the same day in the same battle. George's body was never recovered and he is commemorated on the Thiepval Memorial to the Missing of the Somme, while Fred was given a marked grave at Serre Road Cemetery No. 2. Their brother Henry had also served and was wounded, leaving their parents to face the loss of two sons while a third survived his wounds.

The Harrow Observer described the news as a great loss to William and Emma Slade, reporting that two sons had been killed and another wounded. The tragedy of the three brothers was also recorded in the Newcastle Journal, which noted at the time that the Slades were one of three Harrow families to lose two sons in the recent fighting.

Photos



Slade, Fred – Photo AI



Slade, Fred – Photo Original

The three Slade brothers



Fred Slade (Original Photo)
Killed



Henry Slade (Original Photo)
Wounded



George Slade (Original Photo)
Killed



Fred Slade (AI Photo)
Killed



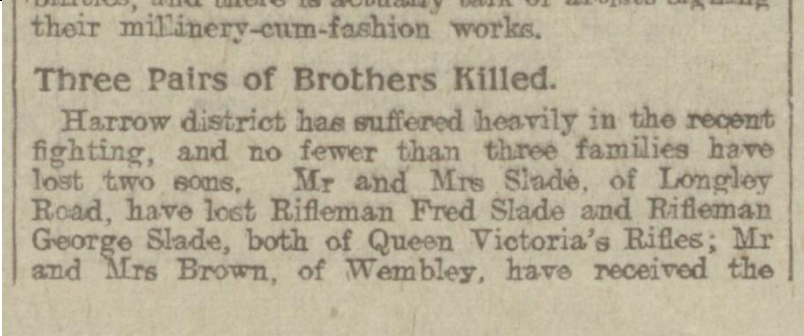
Henry Slade (AI Photo)
Wounded



George Slade (AI Photo)
Killed

The saddest of stories – he was killed along with this older brother George on the same day – they were in the same regiment and same company. The obituary says a bit more. And explains why they're both on the Knutsford memorial. In France they're buried/commemorated on different memorials however. Their other brother, Henry was wounded.

[The remaining lines at the bottom are partially obscured and fragmented]... of the sons was married, and all had ... their parents' home, truth, the blow is ... more distressing to the family. The ... house is inseparable, but there is the ... less consolation for the family, that ... have fulfilled the highest duty and have ... their all, in laying down their lives for ... others.

Newcastle Journal 23/10/1916	
	Newcastle Journal 23/10/1916 Three Pairs of Brothers Killed. Harrow district has suffered heavily in the recent fighting, and no fewer than three families have lost two sons. Mr and Mrs Slade, of Longley Road, have lost Rifleman Fred Slade and Rifleman George Slade, both of Queen Victoria's Rifles; Mr and Mrs Brown, of Wembley, have received the

His Brother George's entry on CWGC <https://www.cwgc.org/find-records/find-war-dead/casualty-details/1553312/george-william-slade/>

This article explains different commemorations as George's body was never found <https://www.londonremembers.com/subjects/george-w-slade>

Story of Two Brothers killed on the same day

<https://www.londonremembers.com/subjects/george-w-slade>

Soldier in the Queen Victoria Rifles killed in Guinchy.

Andrew Behan has researched Slade: Rifleman George William Slade was born on 24 March 1883 in Knutsford, Cheshire, the eldest son and second of the four children of William Slade and Emma Slade née Barnes. His father was a Railway Accountant Clerk. On 14 October 1883 he was baptised at St John the Baptist Church in Knutsford. The 1891 census shows the family living at King Street, Knutsford, Cheshire. Railway records for the Manchester, Sheffield and Lincolnshire Railway, that changed its name to the Great Central Railway, show that he was employed by them in their Goods Audit Department on 27 September 1898 whilst living in Oak Avenue, Romily, Stockport, Cheshire and was paid £20 per annum. This was increased to £30 per annum on 27 September 1899 and to £40 per annum on 27 September 1900. The 1901 census informs that that the family were living at 5 Oak Avenue, Romily and both he and his father were shown as Railway Clerks. The 1911 census shows him with his family residing at 'Neotsford' Longley Road, Wealdstone, Harrow, Middlesex and he is still recorded as a Railway Clerk.

In early 1916, both he and his youngest brother, Fred, who was employed as a clerk by a paper maker manufacturer, enlisted In the 9th (County of London) Battalion, The London Regiment (Queen Victoria's Rifles). His service number was 5808 and his brother's was 5872. Together they entered France on 12 July 1916 and both died on 9 September 1916. He was aged 33 years and his brother was 23 years old. Whilst George has no known

grave and is commemorated on the Thiepval Memorial to the Missing of the Somme, Picardy, France, his brother was buried in Plot 15, Row, 3, Grave 18 in the Serre Road Cemetery No.2, Hébuterne, France.

Probate records show that both he and his brother were living with their parents at 89 Longley Road, Harrow-on-the Hill, Middlesex. On 31 October 1916 his father was granted administration of his estate and his effects totalled £247-4s-5d. On 11 December 1916 his father was sent £4-6s-4d as his army effects followed by a further army effects payment of 1s-9d on 26 March 1917. A war gratuity of £3-0s-0d was sent to his father on 18 September 1919. Both he and his brother were posthumously awarded the British War Medal 1914-1918 and the Victory Medal and both are also commemorated on wooden panels inside what was The Memorial Hospital and is now a day nursery and headquarters of the local branch of the British Red Cross, Memorial House, Northwich Road, Knutsford, Cheshire, WA16 0AW.

Credit for this entry to: Alan Patient of www.plaquesoflondon.co.uk